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United States Patent Application Publication

20250286324

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 11, 2025

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ELECTRICAL CONNECTOR WITH IMPROVED HIGH FREQUENCY PERFORMANCE

Abstract

An electrical connector includes: an insulating housing having a mating groove; and at least one terminal module fixed in the insulating housing and having an insulating bar, a row of terminals arranged along a first direction, a grounding member, and an absorbing member, the row of terminals including plural pairs of signal terminals and plural grounding terminals, the terminals comprising fixing portions fixed in the insulating bar and elastic arms extending into the mating groove, wherein the grounding member and the absorbing member are located at opposite sides of the terminal module in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction, the grounding member has plural grounding fingers abutting against corresponding grounding terminals, and the absorbing member is spaced from pairs of signal terminals and the grounding terminals.

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Family ID: 1000008487553

Appl. No.: 19/073758

Filed: March 07, 2025

Foreign Application Priority Data

CN

202410275129.7

Mar. 11, 2024

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H01R13/6586 (20110101)

U.S. Cl.:

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

[0001] The present invention relates to an electrical connector with improved high frequency performance.

Description of Related Arts

[0002] U.S. Pat. No. 10,320,102 discloses an electrical connector which comprises a housing and two rows of contacts retained in the housing. Each contact comprises an intermediate section and a mating end and a terminating end extending upwardly and downwardly from two ends of the intermediate section respectively. The contacts comprise signal contacts and grounding contacts, signal crosstalk resonance would often occur between signal terminals during high-frequency signal transmitting.

[0003] Therefore, it is necessary to provide an electrical connector with an improved high frequency performance.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0004] The object of the present invention is to provide an electrical connector with an improved high frequency performance.

[0005] To achieve the above object, an electrical connector comprises: an insulating housing having a mating groove; and at least one terminal module fixed in the insulating housing and comprising an insulating bar, a row of terminals arranged along a first direction, a grounding member, and an absorbing member, the row of terminals comprising plural pairs of signal terminals for transmitting differential signals and plural grounding terminals, the terminals comprising fixing portions fixed in the insulating bar and elastic arms extending into the mating groove, wherein the grounding member and the absorbing member are located at opposite sides of the terminal module in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction, the grounding member has plural grounding fingers abutting against corresponding grounding terminals, and the absorbing member is spaced from pairs of signal terminals and the grounding terminals.

[0006] Other advantages and novel features of the invention will become more apparent from the following detailed description of the present embodiment when taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWING

[0007] FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an electrical connector of an embodiment of this present invention;

[0008] FIG. 2 is another perspective view of the electrical connector in FIG. 1;

[0009] FIG. 3 is an exploded perspective view of the electrical connector in FIG. 1;

[0010] FIG. 4 is another perspective view of an insulating housing in FIG. 3;

[0011] FIG. 5 is another perspective view of two terminal modules in FIG. 3;

[0012] FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view of the electrical connector along line A-A of FIG. 5;

[0013] FIG. 7 is a perspective view of two terminal modules in FIG. 5, wherein the two terminal modules are separated from each other;

[0014] FIG. 8 is a front view of the terminal module 20A in FIG. 7;

[0015] FIG. **9** is a rear view of the terminal module **20A** in FIG. **7**;
[0016] FIG. **10** is an exploded perspective view of the terminal module **20B** in FIG. **7**;
[0017] FIG. **11** is a further exploded perspective view of the terminal module in FIG. **10**;
[0018] FIG. **12** is a perspective view of the terminal module **20B**, wherein the insulating housing is removed;
[0019] FIG. **13** is a front view of the terminal module **20B** in FIG. **12**; and
[0020] FIG. **14** is a side view of the terminal module **20B** in FIG. **12**.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENT

[0021] Referring to FIGS. **1-3**, an electrical connector **100** of one embodiment of this present invention is illustrated, which is adapted for mounting on a circuit board. The electrical connector **100** is used for transmitting high frequency signals, and includes an insulating housing **10** with an upper face/mating face **13**, two terminal modules **20** retained in the insulating housing **10** and a mental shell **30**. The insulating housing **10** extends along a longitudinal direction and comprises four side walls **11** and a longitudinal mating groove **12** formed by the four side walls **11**, and the mating groove **12** opens through the mating face **13**. The two terminal modules **20** are assembled together as a whole and then are assembled into the insulating housing **10**, the two terminal modules are located at opposite sides of the mating groove **12**. Two long side walls of the four side walls **11** have plural terminal grooves **14**, and every two neighboring terminal grooves are separated by a rib **141**. Referring to FIGS. **4-5**, contacting portions **221** of the two terminal modules **20** protrude into the mating groove **12** for contacting with a mating connector. The shell **30** surrounds the four side walls **11** outwardly and are spaced from one of the four side walls to form an aligning groove **31**. Preferably, the aligning groove **31** is formed between the shell **30** and one long side wall.

[0022] Referring to FIGS. **5-8**, the two terminal modules **20** have a same structure or are substantially the same, so the two terminal modules can share a same mold. Referring to FIG. **6**, the two terminal modules **20** are in mirror image symmetry, so the terminals of one of the two terminal modules are aligned with the terminals of another terminal module one by one for a better transmitting of high frequency signals. Each terminal module **20** is injection molded with an absorbing member **24** at an outside thereof to absorb external noise. A grounding member **23** is embedded in the insulating housing **10** at each inside of the two terminal modules **20** to avoid signal interference between the two rows of signal terminals. The grounding member **23** abuts against corresponding grounding terminals **22G** of the terminal module **20** to suppress resonance and reduce FEXT of signal transmitting, and thus, a SI performance of the electrical connector **100** can be improved.

[0023] The terminal module **20** will be introduced in detail hereinafter. In order to distinguish the two terminal modules conveniently, one of the terminal modules is labeled **20A** and the other terminal module is labeled **20B**.

[0024] Referring to FIGS. **12-15**, each of the terminal modules comprises an insulating bar **21**, a row of terminals **22** arranged along a first direction or the longitudinal direction, the grounding member **23** and the absorbing member **24**. The grounding member **23** and the absorbing member **24** extend along the longitudinal direction and are located at opposite sides of the corresponding row of terminals **22**. The row of terminals **22** comprises plural pairs of signal terminals **20S** for transmitting differential signals, and grounding terminals **22G** between two neighboring pairs of signal terminals **20S**. Each pair of signal terminals **20S** comprises two adjacent signal terminals **20S**. In order to describe conveniently, the sides of the terminal modules **20** that are close to each other is configured as insides **211** and the sides of the two terminal modules **20** that are far away from each other are configured as outsides **212**. The grounding member **23** is located at the inside **211** of the terminal module **20** and has plural grounding fingers **231** which abut against corresponding grounding terminals **22G** one by one. The absorbing member **24** is located at the outside **212** of the terminal module **20** and does not contact with the signal terminals **22S** and

grounding terminals **22G** as clearly shown in FIG. **14**. Referring to FIG. **6**, each terminal **22** comprises a contacting portion **221**, a fixing portion **222** and a tail portion **223**. The fixing portions **222** of the terminals **22** are embedded and retained in the insulating bar **21**, the contacting portions **221** extend out of an upper face of the insulating bar **21** and the tail portions **223** extend out of a lower face of the bar **21**. The grounding member **23** has two rows of grounding fingers **231**, and one row of the grounding fingers **231** extends upwardly and the other row of the grounding fingers extend downwardly. The grounding fingers **231** extending upward are aligned with the grounding fingers **231** extending downward one by one in an upper and lower direction. In order to describe conveniently, a grounding finger extending upwardly and a grounding finger extending downward are defined as a pair of grounding fingers. A pair of grounding fingers contact with the same fixing portion **222** of a grounding terminal **22G**. The grounding member **23** has plural shielding portions **232**, and each shielding portion is between every two neighboring pairs of grounding fingers **231** and shields corresponding pair of signal terminal **20S**. The absorbing member **24** extends beyond the grounding member **23** both in an upper direction and a lower direction when seen from the longitudinal direction, as clearly shown in FIG. **14**.

[0025] Referring to FIGS. **12-13**, each of the signal terminals of the pair of signal terminals has an outer edge **225** and an inner edge **224** opposite to the outer edge. The inner edges **224** of the two signal terminals of the pair are close to each other. The outside edge **225** of the fixing portion **222** shrinks inwardly relative to the outside edge **225** of the contacting portion **221** so that a width of the fixing portion **222** becomes less to improve high frequency performance of the electrical connector **100**. For the grounding terminal **22G**, a width of the contacting portion **221** and a width of the fixing portion **222** are almost the same. Referring to FIG. **13**, the shielding portion **232** of the grounding member faces and shields corresponding pair of signal terminals **20S**. The absorbing member **24** has plural first openings **241** and second openings **242** over the corresponding first openings **241**. As described above, the shielding portion **232** faces and shields corresponding pair of signal terminal **20S** to reduce signal interference between the two rows of terminals **22**. To prevent the absorbing member **24** from absorbing the energy of normal signal transmission, the absorbing member **24** is kept away from the signal terminals **22** as soon as possible by the first openings **241** and the second openings **242** facing a corresponding pair of signal terminals **20S**. Preferably, to keep away from the signal terminals **22**, each first opening **241** faces and aligns with shielding portions **232** of corresponding pair of signal terminals **20S**.

[0026] Assembling process of the electrical connector **100** is introduced. As shown in FIGS. **10-11**, a row of terminals **22** and the grounding member **23** are positioned, and insulating material is injected to the terminals **22** and the grounding member **23** and then is cooled to form the insulating bar **21**. Absorbing material is injected at an outside of the insulating bar **21** and then is cooled to form the absorbing member **24**. For better combination of the insulating bar **21** and the absorbing member **24**, the insulating bar **21** is provided with plural receiving recesses and bumps at the outside thereof, the receiving grooves accommodate the absorbing material and the bumps go through corresponding openings of the absorbing member **24**. Preferably, the insulating bar **21** has plural first bumps **251** which go through the corresponding first openings **241**. The first openings **241** align with corresponding pairs of signal terminal **20S** one by one. The first bump **251** has a groove **253** penetrates a middle portion thereof and extends along the upper and lower direction.

[0027] The fixing portions **222** of the signal terminals **20S** are exposed in a lower portion of the corresponding grooves **253**, seen clearly in FIG. **10**. The insulating bar **21** has plural second bumps **252** above the corresponding first bumps **251**, and the second bumps **252** go through the corresponding second openings **242** one by one. Similar to the first openings **241**, the second openings **242** are aligned with the corresponding pairs of signal terminal **20S** one by one. Similar to the first bump **251**, the second bump **252** has a groove (not labeled) which aligns and communicates with the corresponding groove **253**. For better fix of the signal terminals, the signal terminal is not exposed in the corresponding groove of the second bump **252**. That is to say, the

pair of signal terminals is embedded in the second bump **252**. Except for the first openings **241** and the second openings **242**, the absorbing member **24** has no other openings and almost covers the whole outside of the insulating bar **21**. Combined with FIG. **4**, two of the first bumps **251** are provided with locking blocks **254** instead of the grooves **253**, the locking blocks **254** go through the corresponding first openings **241** and are bucked in corresponding locking holes **15** of the side walls **11** of the insulating housing **10**.

[0028] Referring to FIGS. **7-8**, the insulating bar **21** has a reference face **261**, plural horizontal ribs **262**, plural vertical ribs **263** and plural horizontal grooves **264**. The vertical ribs **263** and the horizontal ribs **262** protrudes from the reference face **261** along a lateral direction perpendicular to the longitudinal direction. The horizontal grooves **264** recess from the reference face **261** inwardly in the lateral direction. Each vertical rib **263** comprises a recessed portion **2631** and a bulged portion **2632**. The horizontal ribs **262** of one terminal module cooperate with the horizontal grooves **264** of the other terminal module and the recessed portions **2631** of one terminal module cooperate with the bulged portion **2632** of another terminal module **20** when the two terminal modules are assembled together. The horizontal ribs **262** and the horizontal grooves **264** are located at a lower portion of the insulating bar **21**. Vertical grooves **265** are located above the horizontal ribs **262** or the horizontal grooves **264** and face the pairs of signal terminal **20S** one by one correspondingly, and thus, a thickness of the insulating bar **21** facing the pair of signal terminal is thinner. As the contacting portions **221** and the tail portions **223** of the terminals **22** are exposed in the air and the fixing portion **222** are embedded in the insulating bar **21**, a dielectric constant of the fixing portion **222** is different from that of the contacting portion **221** and the tail portion **223**. The thinner the insulating bar is, the minimizer of a difference of the dielectric constant between the fixing portion **222** and the contacting portion **221** is. Grounding fingers **231** of the grounding member **23** are aligned with the reference faces **261** and the vertical ribs **263** in the lateral direction, so the insulating bar at the reference face **261** and the vertical rib is thick enough to support when the grounding fingers **231** keep contact with the fixing portion **222** of the corresponding grounding terminals, and the shielding portions **232** are exposed to the vertical grooves **265**, as shown clearly in FIG. **9**. As the vertical groove **265** is made by removing a tool for fixing the shielding portion **232**, the vertical groove **265** can not only improve the high frequency performance but also fix the grounding member **23**. In other embodiments, the shielding portion **232** may be not exposed in the vertical groove **265**.

[0029] The above-mentioned embodiments are only preferred embodiments of the present invention, and should not limit the scope of the present invention, any simple equivalent changes and modifications made according to the claims of the present invention and the contents of the description should still belong to the present invention.

Claims

1. An electrical connector comprising: an insulating housing defining a mating groove; and two terminal modules fixed in the insulating housing and located at opposite sides of the mating groove, each terminal module comprising an insulating bar, a row of terminals arranged along a first direction, a grounding member, and an absorbing member, each row of the terminals comprising plural pairs of signal terminals for transmitting differential signals and at least one grounding terminal located between two adjacent pairs of signal terminals, each differential terminal pair comprising two signal terminals; wherein the grounding member is located at an inside of each of the two terminal modules proximate to the mating groove and has plural grounding fingers, the grounding fingers abut against corresponding grounding terminals, and the absorbing member is located at an outside of each of the two terminal modules opposite to the inside and separates from the signal terminals.
2. The electrical connector as claimed in claim 1, wherein the absorbing member separates from the

grounding terminals.

3. The electrical connector as claimed in claim 1, wherein the absorbing member is formed at an outside of the insulating bar by an injection molding process.

4. The electrical connector as claimed in claim 2, wherein the insulating bar has plural first bumps extending from an outside thereof, and the absorbing member has plural first openings, the first bumps are received in corresponding first openings, and the pairs of signal terminals face corresponding first openings in a lateral direction perpendicular to the absorbing member.

5. The electrical connector as claimed in claim 4, wherein each of the first bumps has a groove extending along a second direction in which the terminal extends, and the pairs of signal terminals are exposed to corresponding grooves of the first bumps.

6. The electrical connector as claimed in claim 5, wherein the insulating bar has plural second bumps extending from the outside thereof, the second bumps are located above corresponding first bumps, the absorbing member has plural second openings, the second bumps are latched in corresponding second openings, and the second openings are aligned with and face corresponding pairs of signal terminals.

7. The electrical connector as claimed in claim 6, wherein the absorbing member covers the outside of the insulating bar wholly except the first openings and the second openings.

8. The electrical connector as claimed in claim 1, wherein each of the terminals comprises a fixing portion embedded in the insulating bar, a contacting portion and a tail portion extending out of the insulating bar respectively, each pair of signal terminals have inside edges closer to each other and outside edges opposite to corresponding inside edges, and the outside edge of each of the signal terminals is recessed inwardly at the fixing portion.

9. The electrical connector as claimed in claim 1, wherein the insulating bar has a reference face, plural horizontal ribs, plural vertical ribs and plural horizontal grooves at an inside thereof, and the horizontal ribs and the vertical ribs protrude outwardly relative to the reference face, the horizontal grooves recess relative to the reference face inwardly, each vertical rib comprises a recessed portion and a bulged portion, and the bulged portions of one of the two terminal modules cooperate with corresponding recessed portions of the other of the two terminal modules.

10. The electrical connector as claimed in claim 9, wherein the insulating bar has plural vertical grooves at an inside thereof, the horizontal grooves and the horizontal ribs are near a lower portion of the insulating bar, and each of the vertical grooves is located above the horizontal groove or the horizontal rib.

11. An electrical connector comprising: an insulating housing having a mating groove; and at least one terminal module fixed in the insulating housing and comprising an insulating bar, a row of terminals arranged along a first direction, a grounding member, and an absorbing member, the row of terminals comprising plural pairs of signal terminals for transmitting differential signals and plural grounding terminals, the terminals comprising fixing portions fixed in the insulating bar and elastic arms extending into the mating groove; wherein the grounding member and the absorbing member are located at opposite sides of the terminal module in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction, the grounding member has plural grounding fingers abutting against corresponding grounding terminals, and the absorbing member is spaced from pairs of signal terminals and the grounding terminals.

12. The electrical connector as claimed in claim 11, wherein the insulating bar has plural first bumps, the first bumps are received and retained in corresponding first openings defined on the absorbing member, and the first openings face corresponding pairs of signal terminals in the second direction.

13. The electrical connector as claimed in claim 12, wherein the first bump has a groove extending along a third direction perpendicular to the first direction and the second direction, and parts of corresponding pairs of signal terminals are exposed to the corresponding grooves.

14. The electrical connector as claimed in claim 13, wherein the insulating bar has plural second

bumps located above the first bumps, the second bumps are received and retained in corresponding second openings defined on the absorbing member, and the groove extends through corresponding second bump in the third direction.
